

Appendix A

Clearance Shorthand

The following shorthand system is recommended by the Federal Aviation Administration (FAA). Applicants for the instrument rating may use any shorthand system, in any language, which ensures accurate compliance with air traffic control (ATC) instructions. No shorthand system is required by regulation and no knowledge of shorthand is required for the FAA Knowledge Test; however, because of the vital need for reliable communication between the pilot and controller, clearance information should be unmistakably clear.

The following symbols and contractions represent words and phrases frequently used in clearances. Most are used regularly by ATC personnel. By practicing this shorthand, omitting the parenthetical words, you will be able to copy long clearances as fast as they are read.

Example: CAF ~~M~~→ RH RV V18 ↑40 SQ 0700 DPC 120.4
Cleared as filed, maintain runway heading for radar vector to Victor 18, climb to 4,000, squawk 0700, departure control frequency is 120.4.

Words and Phrases	Shorthand
Above.....	ABV
Above (Altitude, Hundreds of Feet)	70
Adjust speed to 250 knots	250 K
Advise	ADZ
After (Passing)	<
Airway (Designation).....	V26
Airport.....	A
Alternate Instructions.....	()
Altitude 6,000–17,000	60-170
And.....	&
Approach.....	AP
Approach Control.....	APC
Area Navigation	RNAV
Arriving.....	↓
At.....	@
At or Above.....	↑
At or Below.....	↓
(ATC) Advises	CA
(ATC) Clears or Cleared	C
(ATC) Requests	CR

Back Course	BC
Bearing.....	BR
Before (Reaching, Passing).....	>
Below	BLO
Below (Altitude, Hundreds of Feet).....	70
Center	CTR
Clearance Void if Not Off By (Time).....	v<
Cleared as Filed.....	CAF
Cleared to Airport	A
Cleared to Climb/Descend at Pilot's Discretion	PD
Cleared to Cross	X
Cleared to Depart From the Fix	D
Cleared to the Fix.....	F
Cleared to Hold and Instructions Issued	H
Cleared to Land.....	L
Cleared to the Outer Marker	O
Climb to (Altitude, Hundreds of Feet).....	↑70
Contact Approach	CT
Contact (Denver) Approach Control.....	(den
Contact (Denver) Center	(DEN
Course	CRS
Cross	X
Cruise	→
Delay Indefinite.....	DLI
Depart (Direction, if Specified).....	T→()
Departure Control	DPC
Descend To (Altitude, Hundreds of Feet).....	↓70
Direct.....	DR
Direction (Bound)	
Eastbound	EB
Westbound.....	WB
Northbound.....	NB
Southbound.....	SB
Inbound.....	IB
Outbound	OB
DME Fix (Mile)	21
Each.....	EA
Enter Control Area.....	△
Estimated Time of Arrival	ETA
Expect	EX
Expect-Further-Clearance	EFC

Fan Marker.....	FM	Reduce Speed 20 Knots	-20 K
Final	F	Remain This Frequency	RTF
Final Approach.....	FA	Remain Well to Left Side	LS
Flight Level.....	FL	Remain Well to Right Side	RS
Flight Planned Route.....	FPR	Report Crossing	RX
For Further Clearance	FFC	Report Departing.....	RD
For Further Headings	FFH	Report Leaving.....	RL
From.....	FM	Report on Course	R-CRS
Ground	GND	Report Over.....	RO
GPS Approach	GPS	Report Passing	RP
Heading	HDG	Report Reaching.....	RR
Hold (Direction).....	H-W	Report Starting Procedure Turn	RSPT
Holding Pattern		Reverse Course	RC
ILS Approach.....	ILS	Right Turn After Takeoff.....	
Increase Speed 30 Knots	+30 K	Runway Heading.....	RH
Initial Approach	I	Runway (Number)	RY18
Instrument Departure Procedure	DP	Squawk.....	SQ
Intersection.....	XN	Standby	STBY
Join or Intercept Airway/Jet Route/Track or Course		Straight-in Approach.....	SI
Left Turn After Takeoff		Surveillance Radar Approach	ASR
Locator Outer Marker	LOM	Takeoff (Direction)	T→N
Magnetic	M	Tower.....	Z
Maintain		Turn Left.....	TL
Maintain VFR Conditions On Top	<u>VFR</u>	Turn Right.....	TR
Middle Compass Locator	ML	Until	/
Middle Marker	MM	Until Advised (By).....	UA
Missed Approach	MA	Until Further Advised	UFA
Nondirectional Beacon Approach.....	NDB	VFR Conditions On Top.....	OTP
Out of (Leave) Control Area.....		Via.....	VIA
Outer Marker.....	OM	Victor (Airway Number).....	V14
Over (Station).....	<u>OKC</u>	Visual Approach	VA
On Course	OC	VOR	
Precision Approach Radar	PAR	VOR Approach	VR
Procedure Turn.....	PT	VORTAC	
Radar Vector	RV	While in Control Area.....	
Radial (080° Radial)	080R		